

Force officials did not know of the highly classified intelligence operations being conducted at that time. As long as the public was convinced that the Air Force was just as curious as the public was, it was the perfect cover.

Q. Was there any UFO activity during the war within the US?

A. There was some pilot sightings and by bomber crews who were in training in B-29's (Project Silverplate) that worried the Pentagon. Unofficially, some had speculated that Dr. Bush and others were involved in some kind of aeronautical designs that were nonconventional aircraft by any standards known at that time. President Roosevelt had authorized a great deal of money into "lift-bodies" technology that was associated with the Manhattan Project and ultimately with military applications.

Embassy and military communications from Japan and Germany were constantly being intercepted and decyphered. I think some of the reports were dealing with Foo Fighters or new spy weapons in the MAJIC (MAGIC) network operations.

In 1938, it was believed that the Army G-2 wanted to test the response of the civilian population by monitoring the CBS radio broadcast of Orson Wells' *War of the Worlds*. Of course, this did create widespread panic in some areas.

There were on several occasions, sightings of huge black objects hovering over Los Alamos in early 1945 which caused severe power blackouts that could not be explained. Wendover was kept informed of this because it was feared that unknown radio propagation could effect the detonation of "Fat Man" and "Little Boy". This was not recorded in the security files for fear of generating panic in Washington. Officially, Los Alamos identified it with "atmospheric anomalies" and left it that way. Some identified it as storm cloud and electrical storm effects. It was never clear what caused the sudden surge of radiation detection or electrical shorts.

The first atomic bomb almost prematurely detonated enroute to Hiroshima when an unknown radio signal almost armed and activated the detonation and trigger mechanisms. It was not known how it happened. The system was corrected.

Q. Was there other Air Force investigations other than Blue Book?

A. Yes.

Q. What were they?

A. Black Sky intelligence operations utilizing high altitude aircraft such as X-2, X-15, and U-2 aircraft.

High altitude, long trajectory rockets equipped with all kinds of cameras and sensing equipment. Television was used on some rockets. White Sands and the Cape were the launch sites from 1947 into the late fifties. All data were classified in a report called, I think, "Blackbook" or "Black-Sky".

I heard of another Air Force project that looked into all the historical records concerning UFO sightings from all over the world. Some of the records were from libraries, newspapers, folklore, mythologies, government records of unusual reports from farmers, lighthouse workers, and so forth. There was talk that the Vatican holds numerous files of sightings going back to the fifteenth century. They also have photos that clearly depict craft of unusual shapes and sizes that are of 1915 period. No one can gain access to this collection. It was rumored that the Vatican even has a UFO locked up in one of the vault rooms inside the Vatican Basilica and would not let the Air Force see it or photograph it. This study was called the "Whitebook".

There was a scientific study that began sometime in early 1948 that involved the astronomical community. I only read a brief memo from Vandenberg that solar astronomy became a concern or was attractive to the Air Force for learning about cosmic radiation effects on aviation electronics.